

K

halid took a deep breath.

“Do you know what happened after Iblis refused?”

Zayd nodded.

“He wanted to prove that Adam was unworthy.”

Khalid looked into his son’s eyes.

“Be careful, Zayd. Never let your goals become about proving other people wrong, Never study so someone else fails.

Never worship so someone else looks smaller.

Never ask Allah to lower another person.”

The moment you want someone else’s downfall...

“You have stepped onto the road Iblis chose.”

“But the moment you ask Allah to make you better than yesterday...”

“You are walking the road Adam chose.”

Zayd was quiet. He understood.

“Last year, I asked you what you would wish for if Allah granted you one wish.”

“You said you wished no one would ever have to feel what you feel.”

Khalid smiled through tears.

“When I was asked that same question many years ago, I wished only for peace.”

He placed his hand over Zayd’s.

“I thought Allah sent me to guide you. But now I think...”

“He sent you to guide me too.”

We are all just souls, waiting to be returned one day to our Lord.

May He accept our repentance, our struggles, and our love.